



According to data from the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), around **17% to 20% of all sexual harassment complaints** are filed by men. Thousands of men report this every year, and many of those cases involve female supervisors or colleagues.

Real-Life Court Cases: Female Aggressor / Male Target

Here are 2 prominent, documented legal cases where women were the harassers and men were the victims:

1. *Funkhouser v. LabOne, Inc.*

- **The Reality:** A male subordinate, Gary Funkhouser, filed a formal federal complaint stating that his female boss, an Executive Vice President of Human Resources, sexually harassed him.
- **The Behavior:** The female supervisor subjected him to unwelcome sexual comments, innuendos, and physical advances during a business trip. When he rejected her advances, she stopped speaking to him, and his performance reviews were suddenly and falsely downgraded in retaliation.
- **The Outcome:** The company ended up settling the sexual harassment lawsuit because the evidence of the female boss abusing her power was undeniable.

2. The Michigan Sheriff Department Case

- **The Reality:** A male county sheriff's officer filed a federal employment lawsuit explicitly alleging that his female boss sexually harassed him for over a year.
- **The Behavior:** The female supervisor taunted him with sexually charged comments, made explicit unwanted propositions, and intentionally gave his male work partners phony assignments just so she could get the male officer completely alone with her.
- **The Complication:** When the male officer complained to higher-ranking male supervisors, they laughed it off and told him to "take one for the team" because they assumed a man shouldn't be bothered by attention from a woman.
- **The Outcome:** The court ruled in favor of the male employee, proving that the law protects men from female supervisors exactly the same way it protects women.

Why Men Don't Report Sexual Harassment

The reason people think this "doesn't happen" is because men are statistically much less likely to report it. Societal stereotypes pressure men to feel like they should "welcome" the attention, or they fear being laughed at by colleagues (just like in the sheriff case above).